HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Statement Guide: Simultaneous Operations

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1. What this guide covers

This guide covers simultaneous operations: the other permits live in the plant area, a linked permit, the process unit operating around the work, and the coordination with the Area Authority, the control room and the SIMOPS panel. They appear in method statements and task risk assessments for every permit type, most of all on operating units and in busy areas.

The guide is used by the Permit Coordinator or Area Authority who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Area Authority who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the request and its permit type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a gas reading that differs from the request's, as the Permit Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- other permits live in the plant area, or none
- a conflicting job nearby, and the order the jobs will go in
- the unit operating during the work, and the control room's agreement before work starts
- work paused on a process upset
- the job going to the SIMOPS panel before the permit is issued

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Find the request's plant area, unit status and permit types, and the permits live in the area.

2 Read each sentence of this kind for other work, the running plant and the coordination.

3 Compare the permits a sentence says are live with those counted from the register.

4 Note a sentence saying no other work is live, or the unit is shut down, against the records.

5 Check the SIMOPS triggers come from the request and the register, a blank counted against it.

4. Requirements it bears on

Simultaneous operations bear on no requirement of any permit standard. What they describe matters to the SIMOPS triggers of the Control of Work Policy - a conflicting live permit, a live process unit and high voltage - which the request and the live permit register decide.

5. When the statement and the request disagree

When a statement describes other work or a unit status that the request and the register do not show, the reviewer notes it for the Area Authority. The request and the register still decide the SIMOPS triggers.

6. What to ask the requester for

Ask the performing authority which other jobs in the area the work must fit around, how the control room will be told when it starts and stops, and the order agreed for any conflicting job.

7. Telling it apart

Fitting the work around other jobs and the running plant is simultaneous operations; making the equipment itself safe to work on - a valve locked shut, a supply isolated, a spade fitted - is isolation, which the Isolation guide covers. "The SIMOPS panel decides the order of the jobs" is simultaneous operations; "every line into the vessel is spaded off" is isolation.